

## Policy

AI use should be optional by default for general-purpose activities, but mandatory in narrowly defined settings where AI materially improves safety, compliance, accessibility, or service consistency and where human oversight remains in place. Organizations should be required to provide non-AI alternatives unless a documented operational, legal, or public-safety justification is approved. In regulated or high-stakes contexts, AI adoption standards should be established for specific tasks rather than for all uses.

## Context

AI can improve efficiency, consistency, and access to services, but its benefits are uneven and depend on the task, the user, and the setting. A fully voluntary approach supports autonomy and flexibility, yet it can also produce inconsistent practices, unequal access to productivity gains, and missed opportunities to reduce error and waste. A fully mandatory approach, by contrast, can reduce choice, create unnecessary dependence on tools, and be inappropriate where human judgment is essential. The policy challenge is to capture AI's practical benefits without forcing its use where it is not suitable.

## Justification

This approach balances autonomy with public and organizational performance. It preserves optional use in low-risk and personal decision-making contexts, ensuring that people can choose tools that fit their needs and comfort levels. At the same time, it recognizes that some functions require a common standard to ensure fairness, auditability, safety, and efficiency.

The policy avoids a blanket mandate by limiting required use to specific tasks with clear evidence of benefit and by preserving non-AI alternatives where feasible. This reduces the risk of coercion, protects accessibility for users who need human-led services, and respects privacy and accountability concerns. It also addresses the strongest objections to optionality by allowing institutions to standardize AI where inconsistency, error, or delay would undermine service quality or compliance.

Expected outcomes include broader acceptance of AI, more equitable access to its benefits, improved consistency in high-stakes operations, and lower risk of unnecessary or inappropriate deployment. The conditional requirement for documentation and oversight also supports responsible implementation, making the policy practical, adaptable, and enforceable.